

Who's making you say this?

ElevenLabs · Instagram Reel · 9:16 · 0:51 · one actor (suspect + detective)

A detective plays a terrified suspect his own recorded threats and makes him repeat them. Each tape is a different voice: calm menace, fluent Hindi, real tears. The suspect can do every one. When the detective finally asks who gave him the words, the answer is "You did." The detective leans into the light. Same face. His case file holds the whole performance, written line by line with emotion tags.

Cast (one actor)

- **ARJUN, the detective.** Dark navy shirt, sleeves rolled, steel watch. Face hidden until 0:35. Never raises his voice. Patient, almost bored: he has heard these takes before.
- **THE SUSPECT.** Arjun's voice given a body. Same face. Crumpled white shirt, top button open, sweat at the hairline, hair a little messier. He starts as the most frightened man in the room and ends as the calmest.

Set and look

- **Room:** interrogation room, darkness beyond the walls. Steel table, two chairs, one low hanging lamp between them. The lampshade is what keeps the detective's face out of the light.
- **On the table from the first wide shot:** a blue Sony Walkman (no headphones), an evidence bag holding three cassettes labelled EXHIBIT A, B and C, and a closed manila folder stamped CASE NO. 11.
- **Palette:** cold, desaturated room with one warm pool of light. Only two things in the film are saturated: the blue Walkman and the purple tags on the case file page.
- **Camera:** each exhibit is shot tighter than the last (MCU, then CU, then ECU). The question and reveal open back up to a symmetrical frame with the lamp in the centre.

Pacing map

Section	Time	Length	What the viewer learns
Hook	0:00–0:06	6s	That voice doesn't belong to that face.
Exhibit A	0:06–0:15	9s	He can switch to the menacing voice on command.
Exhibit B	0:15–0:23	8s	He speaks a language he says he doesn't.
Exhibit C	0:23–0:30.5	7.5s	He doesn't need to be asked anymore.
The question	0:30.5–0:35	4.5s	Everything slows down. Silence.
Reveal	0:35–0:43.5	8.5s	Same face. The file.
Button	0:43.5–0:47	3.5s	"You asked for one."
End card	0:47–0:51	4s	ElevenLabs.

Each exhibit is shorter than the one before, so the film keeps speeding up. Then it stops dead for the question. The silence before "You did." should be the loudest moment in the film.

Shooting script

HOOK (0:00–0:06)

1 · 0:00–0:01 · ECU, Walkman, top-down

A finger presses PLAY. *CLUNK*. The reels start turning. Tape hiss.

TAPE (*calm, menacing*): I know—

2 · 0:01–0:03 · CU, Suspect

Cut while the line is still playing. The voice on the tape is ice cold; the face under the lamp is shaking, eyes wet. He flinches at his own voice.

TAPE: —where you sleep.

3 · 0:03–0:04 · OTS from behind the detective

The detective's shoulder and the back of his head, black against the dark; the suspect beyond him, lit.

DETECTIVE: You said this?

4 · 0:04–0:06 · CU, Suspect

SUSPECT (*scared*): Sir, please... (*gulps*) I didn't have a choice.

EXHIBIT A (0:06–0:15)

5 · 0:06–0:08 · Insert, detective's hands

His hands rest flat on the closed case file, in the light. His face stays above it, in shadow.

DETECTIVE: Say it. Exactly like the tape.

6 · 0:08–0:10 · MCU, Suspect

SUSPECT (*nervous, stammering*): I... I know where you... sleep.

7 · 0:10–0:12 · Insert, detective's hand

One finger taps the table once.

DETECTIVE: No. (*beat*) The way you said it.

8 · 0:12–0:15 · Slow push-in, Suspect

He lowers his eyes. The shaking stops. He looks up. Dead calm, identical to the tape:

SUSPECT (*calm, menacing*): I know where you sleep.

Sound: room tone drops out under the line.

EXHIBIT B (0:15–0:23)

9 · 0:15–0:16.5 · Insert, Walkman

Eject, *CLACK*. EXHIBIT B goes in. Door shut. PLAY, *CLUNK*.

10 · 0:16.5–0:19 · CU, Suspect listening

TAPE (*whispers*): आज रात दरवाज़ा बंद करना मत भूलना।
Subtitle: Don't forget to lock your door tonight.

11 · 0:19–0:20.5 · CU, Suspect

Genuinely lost.

SUSPECT (*confused*): I don't even speak—
DETECTIVE (*O.S., cutting him off*): Say it.

12 · 0:20.5–0:23 · ECU, Suspect

He leans into the light and whispers it back in perfect Hindi, same voice, same breath.

SUSPECT (*whispers*): आज रात दरवाज़ा बंद करना मत भूलना।

EXHIBIT C (0:23-0:30.5)

13 · 0:23-0:24 · Insert, Walkman

One fast, fluid motion. The detective is speeding up too: *CLACK*, EXHIBIT C, *CLUNK*.

14 · 0:24-0:28 · CU, Suspect

The tape starts sobbing. By the second "please", the suspect's lips are already moving with it. His eyes fill. He joins in perfect unison, real tears falling. Nobody asked him to this time.

TAPE (*crying*): Please...

TAPE + SUSPECT (*crying, in unison*): ...please, I'm begging you. (*sobs*) Just let me go home.

Sound: the two voices merge into one. You can't tell them apart.

15 · 0:28-0:28.5 · Insert, Walkman

The detective's finger presses STOP. *CLICK*. Dead silence.

16 · 0:28.5-0:30.5 · CU, Suspect

He wipes his face with the back of his hand. Drained.

SUSPECT (*exhausted*): I only said what I was told.

THE QUESTION (0:30.5-0:35)

17 · 0:30.5-0:33 · Wide, symmetrical

The lamp in the centre. The suspect on the left, in the light. The detective on the right, in shadow. The detective leans forward; his face stops just short of the light.

DETECTIVE: Who gave you the words?

18 · 0:33-0:35 · CU, Suspect

He doesn't look away. He's steady now. A pause.

SUSPECT: ...You did.

Sound: lamp hum only.

REVEAL (0:35-0:43.5)

19 · 0:35-0:38 · MCU, Detective

He leans into the light. Same face. He isn't surprised. The smallest smile. He knew all along.

Sound: one low sub hit as the light lands on his face.

20 · 0:38–0:39 · Symmetrical two-shot

The same man on both sides of the lamp.

21 · 0:39–0:40.5 · Insert, table

He slides CASE NO. 11 into the light, opens it and turns it toward the suspect.

22 · 0:40.5–0:43.5 · Insert, case file page

The speaker chip: "Arjun - My Voice". Tilt down through everything we've heard (menacing, stammering, Hindi, crying) and stop on "You did." The last line stays below frame.

Sound: paper, then a faint tape hiss returns underneath.

BUTTON (0:43.5–0:47)

23 · 0:43.5–0:45.5 · MCU, Detective

Quiet, almost proud.

DETECTIVE: You made me sound like a monster.

24 · 0:45.5–0:47 · CU, Suspect

For the first time, he's the calmest man in the room.

SUSPECT (*deadpan*): You asked for one.

HARD CUT TO BLACK on the last word.

END CARD (0:47–0:51)

25 · Black

Half a beat of silence. The ElevenLabs logo lands on the Walkman's *CLUNK*.

ElevenLabs. Your voice. Whatever the role.

Optional: the suspect's voice reads the line, warm and friendly. It's the first time we hear that voice sound kind, which makes it one last demo.

Every line, by character

SUSPECT (matches the case file page word for word)

1. (*calm, menacing*) I know where you sleep. (*on tape, then live*)
2. (*scared*) Sir, please... (*gulps*) I didn't have a choice.
3. (*nervous, stammering*) I... I know where you... sleep.
4. (*confused*) I don't even speak—

5. (*whispers*) आज रात दरवाज़ा बंद करना मत भूलना। (*on tape, then live*)
6. (*crying*) Please... please, I'm begging you. (*sobs*) Just let me go home. (*tape, then in unison*)
7. (*exhausted*) I only said what I was told.
8. ...You did.
9. (*deadpan*) You asked for one.

DETECTIVE

1. You said this?
2. Say it. Exactly like the tape.
3. No. (*beat*) The way you said it.
4. Say it.
5. Who gave you the words?
6. You made me sound like a monster.

The detective talks less as the film goes on. By Exhibit C he doesn't need to direct at all.

Performance notes

- **Suspect: his status climbs the whole film.** Lowest at 0:00, highest at 0:47. Every switch has to be instant. Don't ease into an emotion: the snap from one voice to the next is the product demo, and the snap is the wow.
- **Detective: flat and patient.** He's never surprised, not even at "You did." His smile at the reveal is pride, not menace.
- **His lines are really direction notes.** "Exactly like the tape" and "The way you said it" should play as an interrogation the first time and as directing on a rewatch.

Rewatch clues

- **A small scar across the left knuckle on both characters.** It's on the finger that presses PLAY at 0:00 and on the suspect's hand when he wipes his tears at 0:28.5.
- **The suspect knows the third tape's words before he hears them.** He's already mouthing along by the second "please".

Sound

- No score. Room tone, lamp hum, tape hiss, and the Walkman's mechanics (PLAY clunk, eject clack, STOP click) are the rhythm section.
- A low drone creeps in at Exhibit B, rises through Exhibit C, and cuts dead on the STOP click at 0:28.
- Tape voice: slightly band-limited, with hiss and a little wow and flutter. The live repeat is clean and close. The performances are identical; only the source differs.

- One sub hit at the reveal (0:35). Nothing else is that loud.
- Master to -14 LUFS, true peak at or below -1 dBTP.

Captions

- Burn in every line. Many people watch Reels muted, and the hook has to land on frame one without sound.
- Tape lines in italics, live lines in roman, so viewers can tell which voice is coming from the Walkman.
- Hindi: English subtitle ("Don't forget to lock your door tonight."), with the Devanagari small above it.

Case file insert

Printed page clipped inside the folder, styled like the voice editor: speaker chip, then each line with its emotion tags. Source and print-ready files: [props/case-file-page.html](#) , [props/case-file-page.pdf](#) (A4), [props/case-file-page.png](#) (preview).

(● Arjun - My Voice)

[calm] [menacing] I know where you sleep.

[scared] Sir, please... [gulps] I didn't have a choice.

[nervous] [stammering] I... I know where you... sleep.

[confused] I don't even speak—

[whispers] आज रात दरवाज़ा बंद करना मत भूलना।

[crying] Please... please, I'm begging you. [sobs] Just let me go home.

[exhausted] I only said what I was told.

[short pause] You did.

[deadpan] You asked for one.

———— + Add speaker ————

- "Arjun" is a placeholder: use the actor's or character's name. "My Voice" on the chip is what makes the connection click instantly.
- The same line appears twice with different tags ([menacing] vs [nervous] [stammering]). That's the payoff of "The way you said it."
- Frame the insert so it ends on "You did." The last line, "You asked for one.", stays below frame so it isn't read before it's spoken. It's on the page for anyone who pauses on a rewatch.

Props

- **Walkman:** a blue and silver TPS-L2-style Sony Walkman, no headphones.

- **Cassettes:** three, in an evidence bag, stickered EXHIBIT A, B and C. Each swap gives a door *clack* that marks the beat change.
- **Case file:** a manila folder stamped CASE NO. 11 (a nod to the brand). It sits closed on the table from the first wide shot, so opening it later feels set up.

Production notes

- **Same actor, both roles.** The detective's face is never seen before 0:35, so a stand-in can play him in every over-the-shoulder and hands shot. Shoot all the suspect coverage first, then the detective's. The two-shot at 0:38 is a locked-off split screen, with the lamp as the seam.
- **If the film is AI-generated,** use one locked character reference for both roles and tell them apart only by wardrobe and hair.
- **The original Walkman has no speaker.** Viewers won't question it. For an airtight version, run a short cable to a small speaker just out of frame.
- **SONY / WALKMAN lettering is a third-party trademark.** If this runs as an official ElevenLabs ad, cover it or angle it away from camera.